

PROJECTMARKET · FOUNDATION

Market Research

Beauty & lifestyle services concept (preliminary)

INTERNAL DOCUMENT

2026-05-15

Preliminary market research from the marketing partner. Translated from Romanian; the original document is on file. This captures the case for the **services** concept (concept (a) in [product-overview.md](#)) with a beauty-and-lifestyle specialisation.

Status

This is **preliminary** research, not a final concept lock. It maps the case for a beauty-and-lifestyle services marketplace: what would differentiate it, who it serves, and a directional aesthetic. Treat it as input to the concept decision, not as committed scope. The codebase remains concept-neutral until the partner moves from *preliminary research* to *concept lock*.

The core idea

A **beauty & lifestyle** application where users can:

- Discover specialists
- Make appointments
- Browse portfolios
- Read reviews
- Explore styles
- Receive personalised recommendations

The important difference

Not "just another booking app." A **premium, feminine, aesthetic, highly personalised** experience.

The real market problem

Many women:

- Already have their own hairstylist
- Are loyal to that person
- Are slow to switch the people they trust

For this reason, the app must **not** sell the idea "*leave your stylist.*"

It must sell: "**Discover good people fast when you need them, wherever you need them.**"

What the app does for clients

- Find good specialists quickly
- Save time
- See the specialist's actual style
- Find services that match their vibe
- Book simply
- Find new people in new cities
- Find urgent / last-minute services
- Discover premium artists

The differentiating idea: "Beauty Match"

Not a random list of salons. The app **reads the user's style** and recommends specialists who fit that vibe.

Aesthetic examples:

- Old money
- Clean girl
- Soft glam
- Dramatic glam
- Natural luxury
- Classy feminine
- Bridal elegance
- (and more — the taxonomy is its own design exercise)

Tagline direction: *"Find the beauty artist that matches YOU."*

This creates:

- A personal experience
- Attachment
- Differentiation
- A premium feel

Acquiring clients

Not through *"Download the app!"*. Through emotional hooks:

- *"We found your beauty aesthetic."*
- *"Finding the right hairstylist feels harder than dating."*
- *"Not every beauty artist understands your face."*

These are strong starting points for TikTok and Instagram content.

Acquiring specialists

The pitch to specialists isn't transactional. It's:

- Branding
- Image
- Exposure
- Status

What specialists receive

A premium profile:

- Clean, on-aesthetic photos
- Mini portfolio
- Video showcase
- Before/after
- Specialisations

Exposure:

- "Featured artist" placement
- Reels on the app's social pages
- Algorithmic recommendation
- Promotion on social media

Target audience

Clients — women, 18–60, interested in:

- Beauty
- Aesthetics
- Self-care
- Luxury
- Premium services
- Comfort

Specialists:

- Hairstylists
- Makeup artists
- Lash artists
- Brow artists
- Nail artists
- Premium salons
- Independent specialists
- Tattoo artists

Marketing concepts (TikTok)

- *"POV: your beauty standards are impossible to satisfy."*
- *"Finding the right hairstylist is harder than dating."*
- *"This app matches you with beauty artists that fit YOUR vibe."*

What makes the app different

It is not just appointments. It is:

- The experience
- The aesthetic
- The personalisation
- The community
- The branding
- The intelligent recommendations

Aesthetic direction

- Very clean
- Very airy
- Very elegant
- Subtly feminine
- Never loud

Suggested colour palette (premium variant)

Token	Direction	Role
Ivory / warm white	very light, slightly warm	Primary background
Champagne beige	soft warm	Accent
Mocha / taupe	warm mid-tone	Secondary text
Soft black	not pure black	High contrast
Sage grey or dusty nude	very desaturated	Optional subtle accent

Exact hex values to be fixed during Figma work. This palette is one concrete direction to evaluate against the warm-neutral and cool-neutral candidates already in [design-brief.md](#). The ivory + champagne + mocha direction is a clear refinement of the **Candidate A — warm neutral** path in the design brief.

How the app should feel

When you open it: *"Ah... it's calm here."*

Not:

- Many banners
- Promotions
- *"-20% LASHES"* shouting

Home page

Top:

Find beauty artists that match your aesthetic.

Below:

- Curated categories
- Large images
- Plenty of space
- No clutter

Categories with personality

Not boring labels like "Hair" or "Makeup". Instead, identity-driven verticals:

- Soft Glam Artists
- Luxury Hair
- Bridal Beauty
- Natural Beauty
- Editorial Glam
- Clean Girl Specialists

Specialist profiles

Treat each profile as a **mini brand page**:

- Aesthetic-driven feed
- "Known for" tags (e.g., *balayage expert*, *blonde specialist*)
- Transformations
- Reviews with photos

How this maps to the foundation

This research aligns with the **services** branch of the concept question in [product-overview.md](#). If the partner moves from *preliminary research* to *concept lock* on this direction, the work in [architecture.md](#) lands as follows:

- **Listing type:** `service` with `fulfillment_model = booking_required`

- **Listing attributes (JSONB):** aesthetic tags, "known for" specialities, service duration, price-per-service, location, before/after media, video showcase URL
- **Discovery surface:** aesthetic-driven categories on top of standard category filters; the "Beauty Match" feature is a layered recommendation system, not a replacement for category search
- **Trust signals:** `phone_verified` and `payment_account_connected` are particularly important for the premium positioning; `manually_reviewed` for "featured artist" slots
- **Concept-specific code:** lands in `src/concepts/services/`
- **Booking calendar:** core requirement; Google Calendar integration valuable for specialists who already run their own schedules

Open questions raised by this research

These are decisions that the research has surfaced but not resolved. Worth flagging before concept-lock:

1. **The aesthetic taxonomy.** "Old money," "clean girl," "soft glam" etc. are useful as starting points, but the final taxonomy needs design and validation. Too few categories and it feels reductive; too many and it loses the curated feel. Likely 8–12 at launch.
2. **Onboarding to surface aesthetic preference.** How does the app *learn* a client's aesthetic? Explicit quiz, photo-based inference, or implicit signal from browsing behaviour? Has cost, accuracy, and friction trade-offs.
3. **"Beauty Match" v1 implementation.** First version is most likely tag-overlap matching (specialists tag themselves with aesthetics; clients pick or are inferred into aesthetics; match on overlap). ML-driven matching is a v2 concern.
4. **Featured artist economics.** Is "Featured Artist" purely editorial (no money changes hands) or is it sponsored? Editorial is more trustworthy; sponsored is monetisable. This connects to the monetisation question in the idea catalogue.
5. **Tattoo artists in a beauty-aesthetic frame.** The research lists tattoo artists alongside hairstylists and lash artists. The aesthetic-matching frame works well for fine-line / minimalist / illustrative tattoo styles, but the booking and trust dynamics differ from a haircut. Consider whether tattoo is in the launch set or a fast-follow vertical.
6. **Calendar integration scope.** Google Calendar two-way sync vs. in-app calendar only vs. both. Two-way sync is the better specialist experience but adds OAuth complexity.